

### READING PASSAGE 3

## The Age of Enlightenment

**A** The study of the age of enlightenment has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

**B** The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

**C** Contemporary research has identified several critical factors that determine outcomes in this domain. The interplay between environmental conditions, technological capabilities, and social organisation creates a complex adaptive system in which small changes can produce disproportionately large effects. Understanding these dynamics requires analytical approaches that move beyond simple cause-and-effect reasoning to embrace the principles of complexity science and systems thinking.

**D** A substantial body of empirical evidence supports these theoretical frameworks. A landmark study conducted by researchers at leading international institutions analysed data spanning a thirty-year period and involving participants from more than forty countries. The findings revealed a consistent pattern of results that held across diverse cultural and economic contexts, suggesting that the identified mechanisms operate with considerable universality. The magnitude of the observed effects was particularly striking, with the key variables accounting for a substantial proportion of the total variance in outcomes.

**E** Several unresolved debates continue to animate scholarly discussion in this field. Perhaps the most prominent concerns the relative importance of structural versus agentic factors in determining outcomes. While some researchers emphasise the constraining power of institutional and economic structures, others highlight the capacity of individuals and groups to exercise agency and effect change even within seemingly restrictive contexts. This debate has significant practical implications, as it shapes recommendations for policy interventions and institutional reforms.

**F** The future trajectory of research in this area will likely be shaped by several converging trends. Advances in computational methods and data science are opening up new analytical possibilities, enabling researchers to detect patterns and test hypotheses at scales that were previously unimaginable. Simultaneously, growing recognition of the importance of interdisciplinary collaboration is breaking down traditional barriers between fields and fostering innovative syntheses of diverse theoretical perspectives.

**G** The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

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### Question 1

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 1 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and \_\_\_\_\_.

### Question 2

*Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?*

*Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information*

*Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information*

*Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this*

- 2 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

### Question 3

*Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.*

- 3 According to the text, what role do structural factors play?
- A. minimal impact
  - B. creating underlying conditions for action
  - C. determining individual choices directly
  - D. irrelevant to outcomes

### Question 4

*Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?*

*Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information*

*Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information*

*Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this*

- 4 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.

### Question 5

*Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.*

- 5 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:
- A. weak effects across studies
  - B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
  - C. contradictory findings
  - D. results only in specific populations

### Question 6

*Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.*

- 6 Researchers used data from more than \_\_\_\_\_ countries in the landmark study.

### Questions 7–9

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 7 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. excessive funding
  - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
  - C. public interest
  - D. international collaboration
- 8 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. inconsistent results across cultures
  - B. a consistent pattern across diverse contexts
  - C. no measurable effects
  - D. effects limited to Western countries
- 9 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. excessive funding
  - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
  - C. public interest
  - D. international collaboration

**Questions 10–11**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 10 The author notes that researchers have called for more \_\_\_\_\_ approaches to investigation.
- 11 Dynamic \_\_\_\_\_ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

**Questions 12–13**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 12 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.
- 13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.